
Debugging is not a talent. **It is a process. Here is mine,** **in 5 steps.**

The same 5 steps, whether it is a CSS glitch or a payment bug.

Swipe >>>

Step 1

Reproduce it reliably

Before touching any code, make the bug happen on demand. Same input, same steps, same failure.

A bug you cannot reproduce is a rumor. You cannot fix a rumor.

If you cannot reproduce it, you are not debugging. You are guessing.

Step 2

Split it into separate failures

What looks like one bug is often three or four stacked on top of each other.

List every distinct wrong behavior you can observe. Then attack them one at a time.

Four small bugs are each easy. One tangled bug is impossible.

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Step 3

Change one thing at a time

Form a hypothesis, make one change, test, write down the result. Repeat.

Change three things at once and even a fix teaches you nothing, because you do not know which change did it.

Debugging is binary search. Every test should cut the space in half.

Step 4

Question the data, not just the code

We assume the code is wrong and the input is innocent. Sometimes it is the reverse.

Corrupt input, missing records, stale caches, wrong environment. Verify what is actually flowing in.

Sometimes the bug is not in the code. It is in what the code was given.

Step 5

Know when the answer is 'stop'

Some problems are not fixable where you are standing.
Missing data cannot be reconstructed by cleverness.

Proving where the problem is NOT, and handing it to the right place, is a senior skill.

The most senior move I know: proving it is not a software problem, and stopping.

I am Umar Farooq.

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Node.js · TypeScript · Angular · React · Laravel · AWS

I am open to work after a company-wide reduction in force.

Looking for: senior full stack or backend roles, remote or Lahore.

My DMs are open

A repost genuinely helps. Thank you.